

A FORGOTTEN UMBRELLA

When Trust turned into an accident



By - Eva Dandelion

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Main Characters

- Vale Josh
- Yellow Shirt Boy
- Vale's Manager
- Elle

Side Characters

This is an ongoing novel. New chapters and characters will be added as the author continues writing.

1.The First ‘Halo’

Vale heard heavy footsteps approaching from behind. Before she could turn around, someone quietly held an umbrella over her head.

She glanced back.

A boy in a yellow shirt stood behind her, holding the umbrella with an almost hesitant expression.

For a moment, neither of them spoke. A strange, gentle silence settled between them. Their eyes met, and there was something mysterious in that fleeting exchange—a glimmer neither of them seemed able to explain.

“Um... sorry.” The boy’s voice trembled slightly. “You should have brought your own umbrella, though.” Vale merely nodded.

Without another word, she turned and walked away. The evening had grown darker, swallowing the streets in its shadows, until Vale disappeared from his sight.

The boy remained where he stood, watching the empty road.

Some encounters lasted only a moment. Some moments, however, refused to leave.

After reaching home, Vale walked straight to her bedroom without uttering a single word. She didn’t bother changing, nor did she spare a glance at anything around her. She simply collapsed onto her bed, exhausted.

The next morning, her mother’s voice echoed through the house.

“Vale! Breakfast is ready!”

Vale was still lying in bed, her eyes half-closed. She murmured something beneath her breath, almost as though she were speaking to someone who wasn’t there.

“It’s already over, God...”

“What is over? What on earth are you talking about, Vale? Wake up!” her mother shouted. “Aren’t you getting late for the hospital and the office?”

“Mom, please! Just five more minutes. I’m exhausted.”

SBefore her mother could respond, Vale's phone began to ring.

She glanced at the screen.

Emergency.

“Doctor, we need you immediately,” an urgent voice came through the phone.

In an instant, the sleep vanished from her face. Vale sprang out of bed, grabbed her car keys, and hurried outside.

“Hey! Keep updating me on the patient's condition!” she ordered over the phone.

Traffic stretched endlessly ahead of her. Every passing second felt like a lifetime, and she was already running late. She gripped the steering wheel, impatiently tapping her fingers against it.

“Update me! I said, keep me updated!” she shouted at the staff over the phone.

“Doctor, the patient's condition is critical. You need to get here as soon as possible!”

Vale leaned forward, her eyes fixed on the road. The honking around her grew louder as the traffic came to a standstill.

Suddenly, someone knocked on her car window.
She turned sharply.

The boy in the yellow shirt stood beside her car.
“Would you please stop honking?” he asked.

For a brief moment, their eyes met again, and recognition dawned on both of them.

“Oh... hello again! How are you?” he asked, offering a small, awkward smile.

Vale stared at him blankly. Without responding, she rolled up the window.

A moment later, another knock interrupted her thoughts.

“Hey! I can help you!”

Vale looked at him through the glass.

“I said, I can help you, if you wish!”

She studied him for a second, then stepped out of the car. Without saying a word, she handed him the keys and her card before walking away.

“The boy stood there, momentarily speechless, watching her disappear into the crowd.

He looked down at the card in his hand.

Then, without wasting another moment, he got into the car.

The operation lasted for more than ten hours.

“Scalpel!”

“Clamp!”

“Cut!”

“Place exchanged. Cut!”

The operating room remained tense, every movement precise, every second precious. Vale's focus never wavered. She worked with unwavering concentration, as though the world beyond those four walls had ceased to exist.

Finally, she placed her instrument on the tray and let out a slow breath.

“The operation was successful.”

The words brought a sense of relief to the exhausted team.

Vale stepped out of the operating room, her shoulders heavy with fatigue. As she walked down the corridor, her eyes fell upon someone sitting on a chair near the wall.

It was him.

The boy in the yellow shirt stood up as soon as he saw her.

“Hello! I came to return your car. I found your address on the card. I was going to wait, but the nurse told me you'd be busy for at least ten hours, so I thought I'd come back just before you finished.”

Vale took the keys from his hand.

“Thank you,” she said quietly.

She turned to leave.

“Josh!” he called.

She didn't turn around.

“I'm sorry,” he whispered.

‘For a moment, the corridor seemed to fall silent. Vale stopped walking, but she didn't look back.

“I'm sorry, Josh,” he repeated, his voice barely audible. “Please... forgive me.”

Vale remained still for a few seconds before continuing on her way.

He watched her leave, his hands curling at his sides.

“Please, just listen to me!” he called, hurrying after her.

But Vale didn't respond.

She walked away as though his words meant nothing—as though the person standing behind her were nothing more than a stranger.

And perhaps, to her, he was.

A man suddenly called out from the corridor.

“Hey! Who are you, and why are you following her?”

The boy froze.

“I... um, nothing! I just came to return her car keys.”

“Oh. All right.”

The man studied him for a moment before asking, “By the way, who are you?”

The boy hesitated, then offered an awkward little laugh.

“Maybe someone special to her. Heh... who knows?”

The man raised his eyebrows.

“Oh!”

“Anyway, goodbye. I need to catch up with her.”

With that, the man hurried away after Vale, leaving the boy standing alone in the corridor.

The boy in the yellow shirt remained motionless, his thoughts tangled beyond recognition.

Was Vale already with someone?

No. No, that couldn't be possible.

‘Days passed.

Then, one afternoon, Vale's phone rang.

“Hey, Vale! How are you?”

There was a pause on the other end.

“Sorry... may I know who's speaking?”

“Dude! It's me! Your best friend! Elle!”

Vale remained silent for a moment.

“I'm sorry,” she replied, her voice distant. “Could you please speak to my manager?”

Before Elle could say anything else, the call ended.

Vale set her phone aside and returned to her bed. Her expression remained blank, as though the conversation had never happened.

Meanwhile, Elle stared at her phone in disbelief.

She doesn't remember me?

After a few moments, she gathered herself and dialled the number of Vale's manager.

“Hello? Am I speaking to Vale's manager?”

“Yes, ma'am. How may I help you?”

“Actually, I'm Vale's best friend. Well... I was her best friend back in school. There's a school reunion taking place this coming Sunday, and I wanted to inform her. We haven't been in touch for a long time.”
There was silence on the other end.

“Ma'am...” The manager's voice trembled slightly. “There's something you need to know.”

Elle straightened in her seat.

“What is it?”

“Vale was involved in an accident twenty years ago. Since then, she hasn't been able to remember anyone from her past, except her family.”

“What?”

‘Elle felt the words settle over her like a sudden storm.

“How did that happen? Why was I never informed? Not even a single person from school told me! I should have been there for her!”

Her voice broke, and tears began to gather in her eyes.

“Ma'am, please don't cry,” the manager said gently. “I understand that this is difficult to believe. But it's the truth. Vale is doing well now. We only ask that you don't try to force her to remember her past. It could be very distressing for her.”

Elle covered her mouth, struggling to process what she'd just heard.

“Oh... okay.” Her voice grew quieter. “Thank you for telling me. And please... take care of my Vale.”

The call ended.

For a long time, Elle sat motionless, staring at the screen of her phone.

Then she remembered something.

Vale had been writing in her diary since she was sixteen.

With trembling fingers, Elle opened the last note Vale had written.

The words stared back at her.

Maybe it's time for me to accept reality.

Maybe I should finally get up, step outside, and let myself breathe in some fresh air.

Goodbye, dear diary.

Elle read the lines again.

And again.

It was the last page Vale had ever written.

Perhaps Vale no longer remembered writing it. Perhaps she had forgotten that she was once a writer, too. Perhaps the things she had loved, the hobbies that had once brought her joy, and the people she had trusted most had all slipped beyond her reach.

Perhaps she had forgotten the person she used to be.

Elle lowered the diary, her eyes blurred with tears.

Maybe it's all over.

Or maybe... somewhere beneath the forgotten memories, a part of Vale was still waiting to be found.

End of Chapter 1.
To be continued...